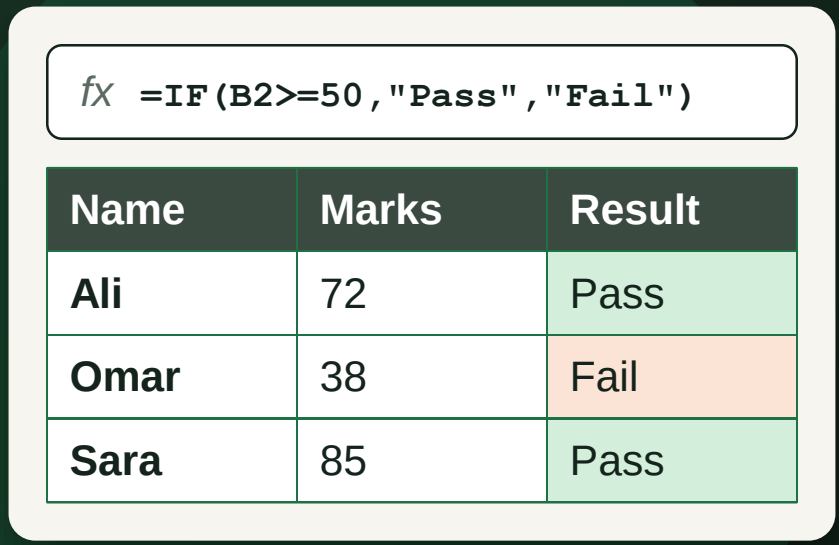
EXCEL COURSE

IF and Conditional Formatting

IF | Highlight | Data Bars | Icons

Learn it, try it, check it



Slides by Sir M Khan Jamali

GOALS

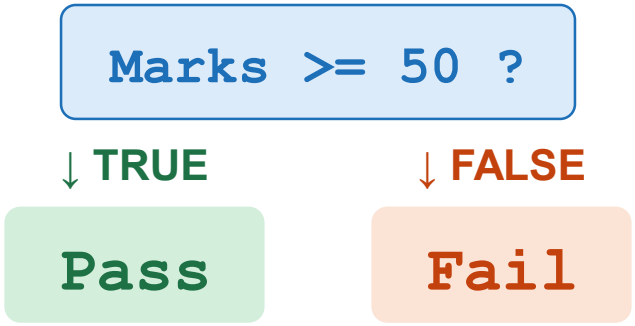
By the end of this unit you can

1. Write an IF formula that gives Pass or Fail
2. Write a test such as B2>=50
3. Highlight cells with a formatting rule
4. Add data bars, color scales and icons

Let Excel make the decision

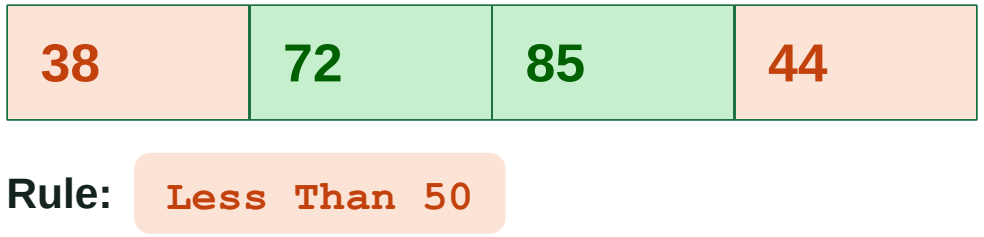
IF FUNCTION

Picks one of two answers, so results update by themselves.



CONDITIONAL FORMATTING

Changes how a cell looks, so high and low values stand out.



IF FUNCTION · 1 OF 2

IF: choose between two answers

THE FORMULA

```
=IF(B2>=50,"Pass","Fail")
```

1 · THE TEST

A question: TRUE or FALSE?

2 · IF TRUE

Shown when TRUE.

3 · IF FALSE

Shown when FALSE.

Watch out: text answers need “quotes”.

IF FUNCTION · 2 OF 2

IF: one formula, every row

FORMULA IN C2

```
=IF(B2>=50,"Pass","Fail")
```

	A	B	C
1	**Name**	**Marks**	**Result**
2	**Ali**	72	Pass
3	**Omar**	38	Fail
4	**Sara**	85	Pass
5	**Zain**	50	Pass

STEP BY STEP · ROW 3

B3 = 38

↓

38 >= 50 ?

↓

FALSE → Fail

Check: change Zain’s marks to 49. What shows?

Highlight Cells Rules

THE STEPS

1. Select the cells, F2:F6
2. Home → Conditional Formatting
3. Highlight Cells Rules → Greater Than…
4. Type 300, choose Green Fill with Dark Green Text, click OK

Same menu: Less Than · Between · Equal To · Text that Contains

BEFORE AND AFTER

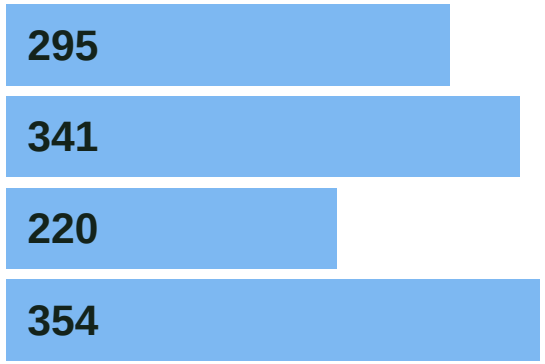
Before	After
295	295
341	341
220	220
354	354
260	260

Rule: `Greater Than 300`

CONDITIONAL FORMATTING · 2 OF 2

Three more ways to format

DATA BARS



Bar length shows size.

COLOR SCALES



Darker means higher.

ICON SETS

▲ 354

▲ 341

► 295

▼ 220

Icons show the rank.

Find them: Home → Conditional Formatting. **Remove:** Clear Rules.

PRACTICE 1 · IF · WORK ALONE, THEN COMPARE WITH A PARTNER

Practice: pass or fail?

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G
1	Student	English	Maths	Science	History	Total	Result
2	Ali	72	68	80	75		
3	Sara	85	90	78	88		
4	Omar	54	60	48	58		
5	Hina	90	82	95	87		
6	Zain	62	58	69	71		

Fill in: `Total: SUM` `Result: IF Total >= 280`

Start with Ali: his marks are in B2:E2.

Exit ticket: change Zain's History to 91. What is his Result?

PRACTICE 2 · CONDITIONAL FORMATTING · WORK ALONE, THEN COMPARE WITH A PARTNER

Practice: format the markbook

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G
1	Student	English	Maths	Science	History	Total	Result
2	**Ali**	72	68	80	75	295	Pass
3	**Sara**	85	90	78	88	341	Pass
4	**Omar**	54	60	48	58	220	Fail
5	**Hina**	90	82	95	87	354	Pass
6	**Zain**	62	58	69	71	260	Fail

`Total: Greater Than 300` → **Green Fill with Dark Green Text**

`Result: Text that Contains Fail` → **Light Red Fill with Dark Red Text**

Start with Total: select F2:F6 first.

Exit ticket: change Ali's English to 90. What happens to his Total?

BONUS EXERCISE · SALES TEAM

Bonus: quarterly sales tracker

	A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H
1	**Name**	**Jan**	**Feb**	**Mar**	**Total**	**Average**	**Best**	**Target**
2	**Bilal**	120	95	160				
3	**Fatima**	80	100	90				
4	**Usman**	150	130	140				
5	**Ayesha**	60	85	80				
6	**Hamza**	95	110	110				

Fill in: `Total: SUM` `Average: AVERAGE` `Best: MAX` `Target: IF Total >= 300`

- **Then format:** blue Data Bars on Total; Light Red Fill with Dark Red Text on every No.
- **Check:** Fatima’s total is 270 and her Target is No.